Conference Forward

IRI 2026

We would like to extend our warmest welcome to all the conference attendees. This is the 27th year for the IEEE IRI conferences! Our conference has become known worldwide for its exceptionally high-quality papers, showcasing re-search solutions that address all facets of data and information reuse and integration in today's era of AI and data science. AI and data science enable the discovery of knowledge and patterns from massive datasets, transforming raw information into actionable, real-world insights for fast, smart decision-making. The IRI conferences have attracted many people from academia, industry, and government to present, discuss, and exchange ideas that address real-world problems with real-world solutions. The topical emphasis of IRI is subdivided into three major tracks: **information reuse, information integration, and reusable systems**. Data science, or the study of methodologies for extracting knowledge from data, defines an ever-expanding collection of techniques for knowledge-based reuse and integration.

This year's conference continues to honor the memory of Dr. Stuart Rubin, our Honorary General Chair. Dr. Rubin was among the warmest of personalities and had been with IRI since day one. He founded the IRI conference in 1999 to promote AI research. He was a pioneer in AI. He will be missed but not forgotten.

The conference is also sponsored by the Socie-ty for Information Reuse and Integration (SIRI). The purpose of this society is to foster the vision of the IEEE IRI Conferences: to deliver "more for less through reuse and integration".

Information reuse is not merely an academic slant on some technical approach. Rather, it defines the basis for symmetric search processes. Its antithesis, randomness, defines knowledge that does not immediately follow from transformations of existing knowledge. Everything from hardware to software to knowledge can be couched as some combination of randomness and symmetry. The IRI Conference seeks to advance and publish all theoretical and applied computational techniques that define these abstract concepts.

Finally, we would like to thank the organizing and program committee members for their dedication and notable efforts on behalf of the conference. It would not have been possible to produce this directed, cutting-edge, and successful conference without their contributions. We also wish to thank the IEEE Computer Society for financial support of the IRI conferences and for their commitment and assistance in helping us achieve our stated goals.

General Chair
Shu-Ching Chen, *University of Missouri-Kansas City, United States*